

SAMANTHA ARIAS

Professional Profile

Senior QA/Testing professional, 14 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: Playwright, CI/CD, Java.

Education and Training

Master, Biology

Marchmont University | 2010 — 2011

Dean's List (2 years)

Bachelor, Biology

Westfield State University | 2007 — 2010

Career History

Beacon Interactive — Senior Test Automation Engineer

2022-04 — Present

- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 30% to 96%.
- Integrated automated checks into the Docker pipeline, blocking 6 faulty releases.
- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 4 hours to 4 minutes through parallelisation.

Senior SDET

Lumen Works | 2018-10 — 2021-11

- Built a performance harness in CI/CD simulating 50k concurrent users.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Playwright, catching defects staging had missed.
- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.

QA Analyst, Vantage Analytics

2012-01 — 2018-07

- Owned release sign-off for 50 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Automated 3 regression suites with Postman, cutting the manual test cycle by 22%.

Core Competencies

Playwright | CI/CD | Java | Docker | TypeScript | Jira | Selenium | Postman | Cypress | MySQL | Bash | Hugging Face | REST APIs

Open Source

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on CI/CD.

Certificates

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2025

TensorFlow Developer Certificate — Google, 2019

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2024

Publications

"Population modelling under habitat fragmentation" - technical report, 2012. Cited internally as the basis for the current design.